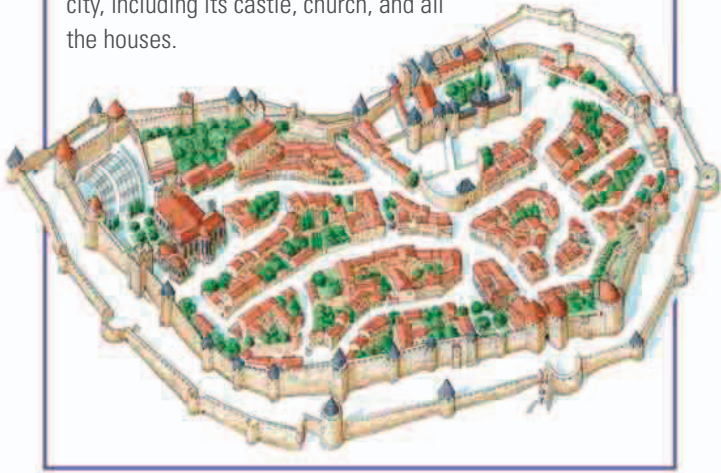


CITY WALLS

In the past, wealthy cities were a target for bandits and armies. Many were defended by walls and towers, plus ditches and secondary walls. This image of Carcassonne in medieval France shows how the walls surrounded the entire city, including its castle, church, and all the houses.



MASTER PLANS

Most ancient cities grew over time without any real planning, and many of their winding streets were once country roads. But some cities were built according to an organized plan—this aerial view of Amsterdam in the Netherlands shows its 17th-century web of semicircular canals. Modern cities are usually laid out on a grid plan of rectangular blocks.



▲ HONG KONG SKYSCRAPERS

Perched between hills and sea on China's south coast, Hong Kong is home to 7 million people.

▼ GATEWAY TO THE EAST

Wealthy Samarkand in Central Asia lay on the Silk Road—the medieval trade route between China and the Mediterranean. It is now the second largest city in Uzbekistan.

